



Dr.I



FXVIII



F27 Friendship



F100

- 1890** Anthony Fokker is born in the Dutch East Indies.
- 1910** Aged 20, Fokker designs and builds his first airplane, the Spin (Spider).
- 1912** Fokker founds Fokker Aeroplanbau in Berlin, Germany.
- 1914** World War I begins, and the German government takes control of Fokker Flugzeugwerke GmbH.
- 1915** The Fokker Eindecker fighter enters service, and the so-called "Fokker Scourge" begins.

- 1918** World War I's top-scoring fighter ace—Rittmeister Manfred von Richthofen (the "Red Baron")—is killed in a Fokker Dr.I Dreidecker on April 21.
- 1919** Fokker returns to the Netherlands and commences production of several different aircraft types.
- 1923** Fokker relocates to the United States, and sets up an American division called the Atlantic Aircraft Corporation.
- 1925** Fokker Trimotor wins the Ford Reliability Tour.

- 1926** A Fokker FVII flies over the North Pole.
- 1928** A Trimotor flies from America to Australia, and then from Australia to New Zealand.
- 1930** General Motors buys the Fokker Aircraft Corporation.
- 1932** The FXVIII is launched.
- 1939** Anthony Fokker dies in New York.
- 1958** The hugely successful F27 Friendship enters service. It becomes the best-selling turboprop airliner.
- 1967** The prototype F28 jetliner is tested.

- 1969** In collaboration with German company VFW, Fokker builds the VFW-614 regional jetliner.
- 1986** Work begins on the F50 and F100.
- 1987** As development costs spiral on the two new aircraft, the Dutch government grants the company a 212 million guilders bailout.
- 1992** Fokker merges with DASA, a subsidiary of Daimler-Benz.
- 1996** Daimler-Benz ends the arrangement, and Fokker is declared bankrupt.

However, the Fokker brand was badly tarnished in 1931 when a Fokker Trimotor, TWA Flight 599, crashed. Not only was the cause of the disaster traced to structural failure caused by wood rot, but legendary football coach Knute Rockne was one of the casualties, ensuring extensive media coverage. The aircraft were grounded for a time following the accident, allowing all-metal aircraft by Boeing and Douglas to become

more prevalent. Having sold the company to General Motors in 1930, Fokker was increasingly sidelined by the GM management and resigned the following year. He died from pneumococcal meningitis in New York City on December 23, 1939, aged only 49.

In the Netherlands the Fokker factories were confiscated by the Germans after they invaded in 1940, and were used to build Bucker Bu181 trainers and as parts for Ju-52 transports. After World War II, the company initially converted



surplus Douglas Dakotas for civilian use, before designing and building some new types, including the S11 trainer and one of the first jet trainers, the S14. They also built jets such as the Gloster Meteor and Lockheed F-104 Starfighter, under license.

In 1957 Fokker began work on the F27 Friendship. Powered by a pair of Rolls-Royce Dart turboprops, the F27 would eventually become the most successful European turboprop airliner and continued in production until 1987. A small jetliner, the F28 Fellowship, launched in 1967, also sold well. At the same time, the company built satellites and was part of the consortium that built F16s under license for the Belgian, Danish, Dutch, and Norwegian air forces. However, an ambitious project to

Fokker factory

First brought into service in 1987, the F50—here being assembled in a factory—remains in use by several airlines, although it went out of production in 1996.

develop two new aircraft concurrently was to prove Fokker's undoing. While developing the F50 (which was based on the F27) and the F100 (derived from the F28) costs spiraled, and Fokker required a large bailout from the Dutch government to remain solvent. Furthermore, although initially both types sold reasonably well, they did not repeat the successes of the types they were based on. Eventually, the company merged with German company DASA in 1992, but DASA's parent company Daimler-Benz had problems of its own, and in January 1996 it split with Fokker. Two months later Fokker was declared bankrupt. However, the name still exists within the aerospace sector, as Fokker Technologies, a consortium of five individual companies.

Fokker DR.I

Ace German pilot Heinrich Gontermann poses with his Fokker Dr.I before World War I. The plane was also flown by the "Red Baron." Both pilots lost their lives in air combat.

